

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 6: THE ARTIST (BY SHIGA NAOYA)

CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"The Artist" is a touching short story by Shiga Naoya. It tells the story of Seibei, a talented twelve-year-old boy passionate about collecting and polishing gourds. Unfortunately, his traditional father and a strict teacher crush his artistic talent, highlighting how society often destroys children's unique creativity.

15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Who was Seibei and what was his hobby?

Ans: Seibei was a twelve-year-old Japanese boy studying in a primary school, and his hobby was collecting, cleaning, and polishing gourds.

Q2. What did Seibei do after buying a gourd?

Ans: As soon as Seibei bought a gourd, he would make a neat hole at the top, extract the seeds, apply tea-leaves to remove the smell, and polish it carefully.

Q3. Why did Seibei's father dislike his hobby?

Ans: His father believed that collecting gourds was a useless and effeminate waste of time, and he wanted Seibei to focus strictly on his school studies.

Q4. What happened when the ethics teacher caught Seibei with a gourd in class?

Ans: The ethics teacher became furious because Seibei was secretly polishing a gourd under his desk during class, which the teacher considered a grave sin.

Q5. How did the ethics teacher react when he visited Seibei's house?

Ans: The teacher scolded Seibei's mother, called Seibei a lost cause with no future, and handed over the confiscated gourd to an old porter of the school.

Q6. What did Seibei's father do when he found out about the school incident?

Ans: Seibei's father became intensely angry, grabbed a heavy hammer, and systematically smashed all of Seibei's beautifully polished gourds to pieces.

Q7. Who was the porter and what did he do with Seibei's gourd?



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Ans: The porter was a school servant. He kept the gourd given by the teacher and later sold it to a local curio-dealer out of necessity for some money.

Q8. For how much did the porter sell the gourd to the curio-dealer?

Ans: The old porter sold Seibei's special gourd to the curio-dealer for 50 yen, which was equal to a whole year's salary for him.

Q9. For how much did the curio-dealer sell that same gourd to a wealthy collector?

Ans: The clever curio-dealer sold Seibei's masterpiece gourd to a wealthy district collector for a massive sum of 600 yen.

Q10. What new hobby did Seibei adopt after his gourds were destroyed?

Ans: After his gourds were destroyed, Seibei quietly adopted the hobby of drawing and painting pictures, though his father began scolding him for that too.

Q11. Why did the ethics teacher fail to understand Seibei's artistic talent?

Ans: The teacher was rigid and old-fashioned. He only valued textbook learning and viewed a child's creative passion as a waste of time and an act of misbehavior.

Q12. How did Seibei locate the unique 5-inch gourd that became his masterpiece?

Ans: While walking through an unfamiliar part of the harbor town, Seibei noticed an old woman selling dried gourds, where he spotted the perfect five-inch gourd.

Q13. What type of town did Seibei live in, and how did it affect his hobby?

Ans: Seibei lived in a small harbor town. It was small enough that he could walk from one end to the other in twenty minutes, giving him easy access to all gourd shops.

Q14. What does the title "The Artist" signify in this story?

Ans: The title signifies that Seibei was not just a regular boy playing with toys, but a true artist who possessed a deep vision for beauty, symmetry, and creation.

Q15. What is the central message of Shiga Naoya's story?

Ans: The central message is that parents and teachers should recognize and nurture a child's natural talents rather than forcing them into traditional academic molds.

 50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'The Artist' is written by the celebrated writer: (A) Shiga Naoya (B) H.E. Bates (C) Anton Chekhov (D) Guy de Maupassant

2. Shiga Naoya is a well-known _____ short story writer.: (A) Indian (B) Japanese (C) Chinese (D) American

3. Shiga Naoya was born in the year 1883 and died in: (A) 1948 (B) 1961 (C) 1971 (D) 1980



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4. Seibei was a _____ year old boy.: (A) ten (B) twelve (C) fifteen (D) eight
5. Seibei was still at _____ school.: (A) primary (B) high (C) middle (D) college
6. Seibei's unique passion and hobby was collecting: (A) coins (B) stamps (C) gourds (D) stones
7. Seibei lived in a small: (A) village (B) harbor town (C) forest (D) mega city
8. One could walk from one end of Seibei's town to the other in: (A) 10 minutes (B) 20 minutes (C) an hour (D) two hours
9. Seibei used to polish his gourds with: (A) tea-leaves and alcohol (B) water only (C) paint (D) oil
10. Seibei's father worked at a _____ shop.: (A) grocery (B) carpenter's (C) goldsmith's (D) blacksmith's
11. Whenever Seibei went out, he searched exclusively for: (A) money (B) gourds (C) friends (D) books
12. An old woman was selling gourds on her stall near the: (A) school (B) harbor / street (C) temple (D) river
13. Seibei bought a beautiful five-inch gourd from the old woman for: (A) 10 sen (B) 50 sen (C) 5 yen (D) 10 yen
14. The teacher caught Seibei polishing his gourd during the _____ class.: (A) Mathematics (B) Ethics (C) History (D) Science
15. The ethics teacher came from another part of Japan and disliked the town's interest in: (A) music (B) gourds (C) ships (D) sports
16. The teacher considered Seibei's activity in class as a grave: (A) achievement (B) crime / sin (C) joke (D) art
17. The teacher confiscated Seibei's gourd and gave it to the school: (A) Principal (B) Porter / Servant (C) Monitor (D) Clerk
18. When the teacher reached Seibei's house, Seibei's father was at: (A) home (B) work / shop (C) market (D) school
19. The teacher furiously scolded Seibei's: (A) father (B) mother (C) sister (D) grandfather
20. When Seibei's father came home and heard the story, he became: (A) happy (B) sad (C) absolutely furious (D) silent
21. Seibei's father used a _____ to destroy all the gourds hanging on the wall.: (A) stone (B) stick (C) hammer (D) knife
22. Seibei did not cry or shout while his father was: (A) laughing (B) smashing his gourds (C) working (D) sleeping
23. The school porter kept Seibei's gourd in his room for _____ months.: (A) two (B) three (C) five (D) twelve
24. The porter took the gourd to a local _____ dealer to get some money.: (A) fish (B) curio (C) cloth (D) book



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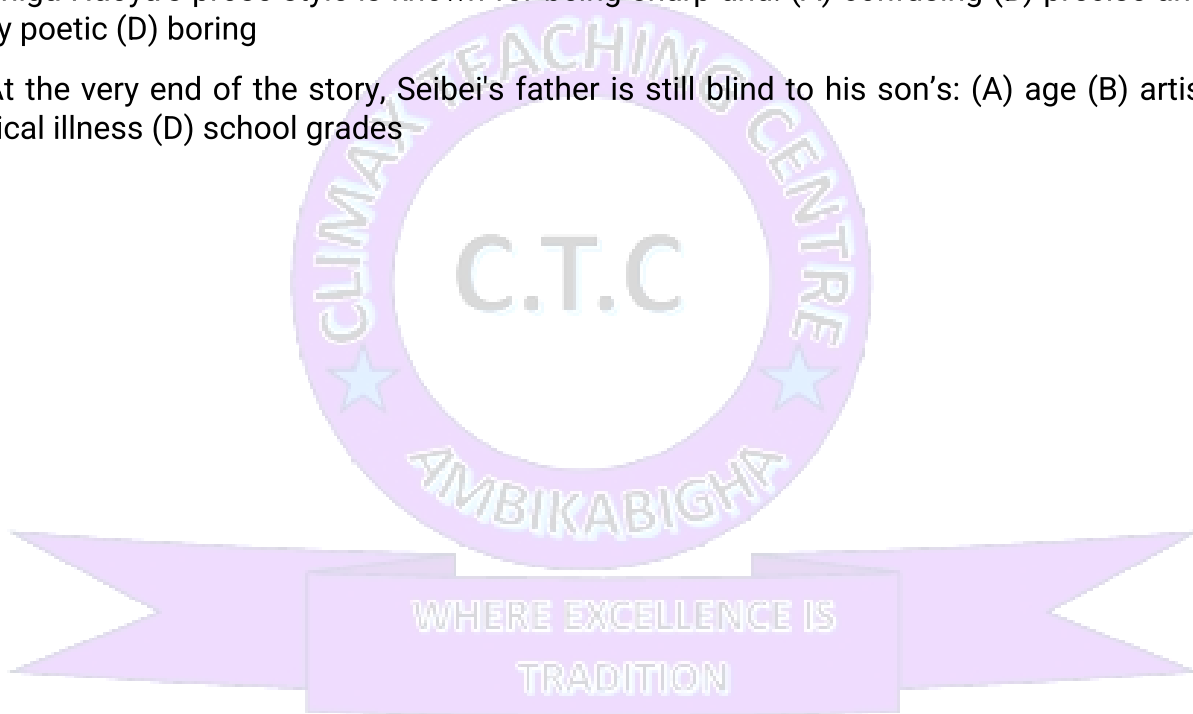
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25. The curio-dealer initially offered the porter _____ yen for the gourd.: (A) 5 (B) 10 (C) 40 (D) 50
26. Finally, the porter sold the gourd to the curio-dealer for: (A) 10 yen (B) 50 yen (C) 100 yen (D) 600 yen
27. The porter was extremely happy because 50 yen was equal to his: (A) daily wage (B) monthly income (C) year's salary (D) life savings
28. The curio-dealer later sold Seibei's gourd to a wealthy district collector for: (A) 50 yen (B) 100 yen (C) 500 yen (D) 600 yen
29. Nobody ever found out that the masterpiece gourd belonged originally to: (A) the teacher (B) the porter (C) Seibei (D) the old woman
30. After the destruction of his gourds, Seibei quietly took up: (A) singing (B) painting pictures (C) running (D) reading novels
31. Seibei's father eventually began to scold him for his new hobby of: (A) writing (B) painting (C) farming (D) fishing
32. The story displays how the adult world destroys children's: (A) health (B) property (C) innate creativity (D) clothes
33. Before the 5-inch gourd, Seibei was interested in gourds that were: (A) long and asymmetrical (B) normal and round (C) very large (D) artificial
34. Seibei's friend thought that baking a gourd looked: (A) artistic (B) stupid and dirty (C) elegant (D) scientific
35. The old woman's stall had a collection of clustered: (A) fruits (B) gourds (C) toys (D) clothes
36. Seibei carried his new 5-inch gourd everywhere, even to: (A) bed (B) school (C) toilet (D) playground
37. The ethics teacher believed that boys should not indulge in such _____ hobbies.: (A) masculine (B) feminine / useless (C) professional (D) expensive
38. Seibei's mother was crying bitterly when the teacher was: (A) praising Seibei (B) shouting at her (C) eating food (D) paying money
39. Seibei hid himself in the _____ when his father was venting anger.: (A) kitchen (B) corner / under the bed (C) school (D) shop
40. The text describes Seibei as a boy who was always absorbed in: (A) daydreams (B) his work / gourds (C) fights (D) games
41. Curio-dealers are businessmen who deal in rare and: (A) fresh vegetables (B) antique/artistic items (C) heavy machines (D) textbooks
42. The main conflict in the story is between an artist and a rigid: (A) government (B) society/family (C) nature (D) climate
43. "The Artist" is fundamentally a _____ story.: (A) tragic and satirical (B) horror (C) science fiction (D) romantic
44. Seibei's town was known as a famous: (A) hill station (B) harbor (C) desert oasis (D) capital city



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45. Seibei used to make a hole in the top of the gourd to extract the: (A) juice (B) seeds (C) air (D) water
46. The smell of the gourd was neutralized by using: (A) perfume (B) tea-leaves (C) milk (D) soap
47. Seibei's father wanted him to become a truly _____ citizen.: (A) artistic (B) respectable / conventional (C) wealthy (D) military
48. The phrase "lost cause" used by the teacher meant that Seibei had no: (A) money (B) future (C) past (D) mistakes
49. Shiga Naoya's prose style is known for being sharp and: (A) confusing (B) precise and realistic (C) highly poetic (D) boring
50. At the very end of the story, Seibei's father is still blind to his son's: (A) age (B) artistic talent (C) physical illness (D) school grades



SUJIT KUMAR

